

Profitable.

It's the most used word in startups. It's also the least meaningful one.

1,000 verified businesses. One frozen dataset. One uncomfortable truth.

The Data Comes From TrustMRR

TrustMRR is a verified revenue intelligence platform used by thousands of independent businesses to track, validate, and share real revenue data. It is one of the few sources in the bootstrapped and indie founder space where revenue figures are timestamped and independently verified - not self-reported estimates.

This report draws from a frozen snapshot of 1,000 businesses on TrustMRR, captured July 30, 2026. Every figure cited is sourced directly from that dataset.

Source: TrustMRR · Dataset frozen July 30, 2026 · 1,000 verified businesses

What We're Looking At

1,000 businesses. Verified revenue. Every one self-labeled as profitable. Source: TrustMRR, frozen July 30, 2026.

Not a survey. Not estimates. Timestamped, verified revenue data - one snapshot in time. The word "profitable" is where the story begins.

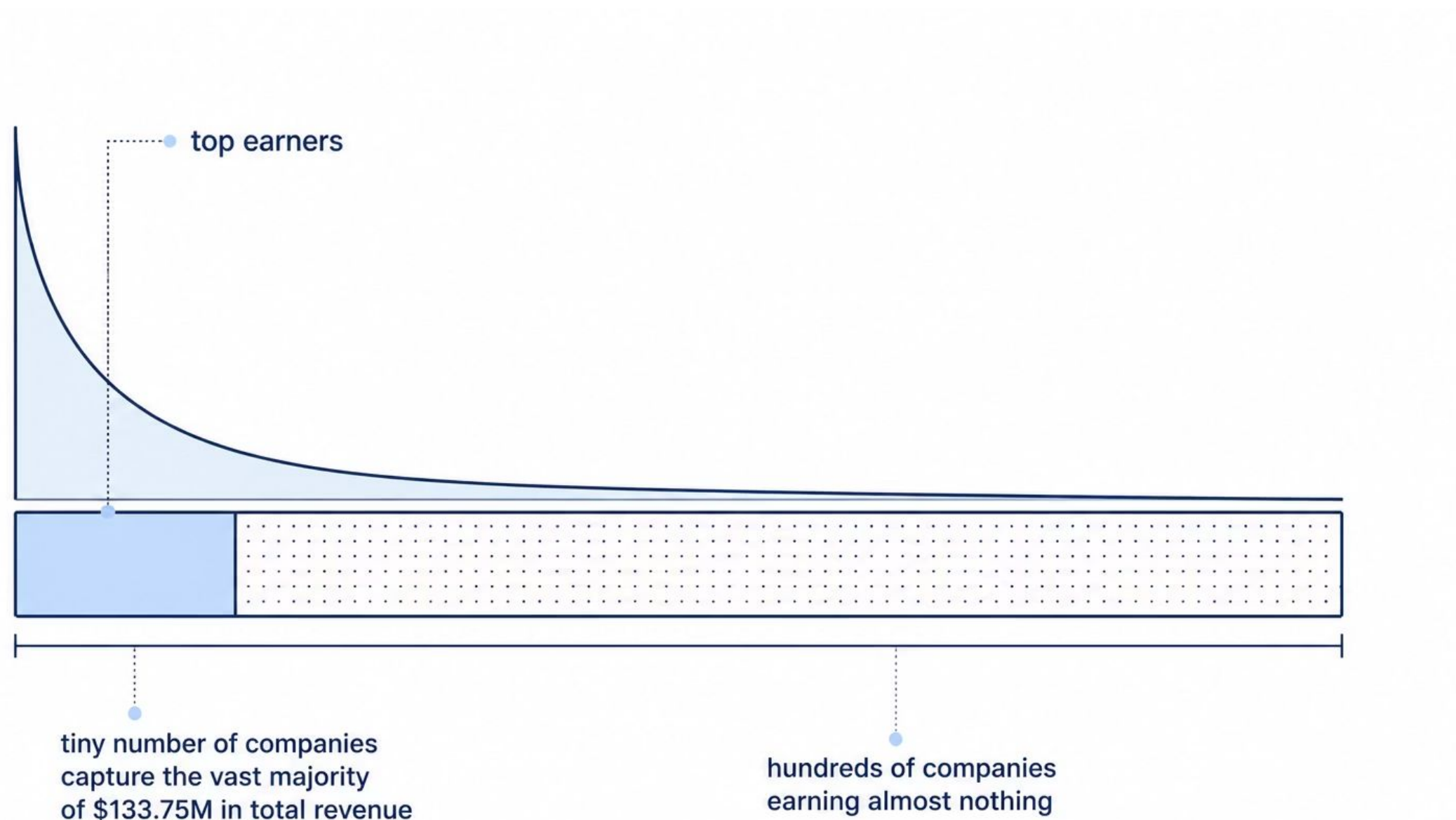
\$3,069

The median annual revenue of a "profitable" business.

Not the average. The middle. Half of all 1,000 businesses earn less than this - per year.

The Money Isn't Spread. It's Stacked.

Total revenue across all 1,000 companies: \$133.75 million. But this isn't a distribution - it's a cliff. A handful of companies sit at the top. The rest share almost nothing.



10 Companies. Half the Money.

Out of 1,000 businesses, just 10 capture 51% of all revenue. That's 1% of the group holding half the pool.

10

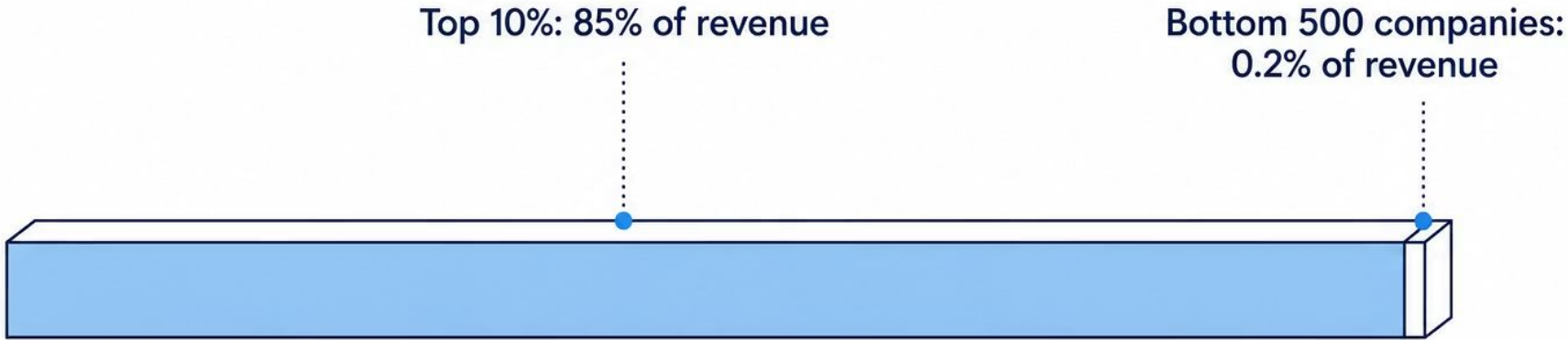
companies

51%

of all revenue

The Bottom Half Shares Almost Nothing.

The top 10% of companies hold 85% of all revenue. The bottom 500 - half the dataset - share just 0.2%. Same label. Completely different reality.



85%

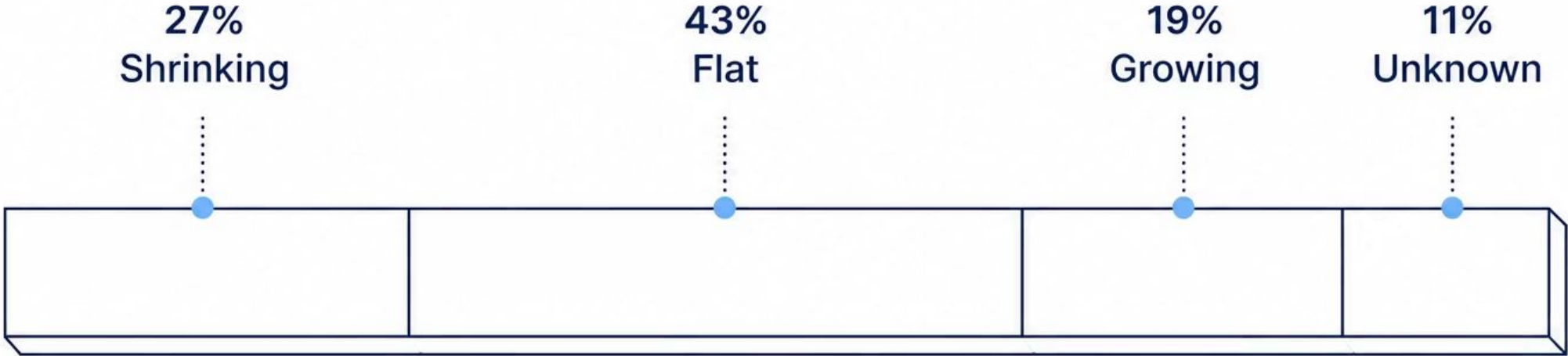
top 10% of companies

0.2%

bottom 500 companies

Most of Them Aren't Going Anywhere.

Profitable doesn't mean growing. 70% of these businesses are flat or shrinking. Only 19% are actually moving forward.



The Boring Category Pays 4× More.

More founders are building for consumers. More money is in building for businesses. The gap between where attention goes and where revenue concentrates is roughly 4 to 1.

B2B

4× higher median revenue

Fewer builders. More money.

B2C

More builders. Less money.

"Profitable" Covers a \$37 Side Project and a \$25M Company.

\$37

A side project. One customer. Billed monthly.

\$25M

A company. A team. A real business.

Both founders used the same word. The language never distinguished them. The data does.

The lie isn't that they're wrong. It's that the word stopped meaning anything.

Stop Asking "Is It Profitable." Start Asking "Where Does It Sit."

The question was never is it profitable. It's where does it sit - and is it moving. Position and trajectory. Everything else is noise.

51%

of revenue captured by just 10 companies

\$3,069

median annual revenue - the number the
word hides

70%

flat or shrinking, right now